

Platform and Test Engineer: Job Description for HR and Recruiters

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Also known as: SDET; Test Automation Engineer; DevOps Engineer who codes; Platform Engineer; Build and Release Engineer

Experience	4 to 7 years, on a software product that real users depended on
Salary	INR 18 to 28 lakh a year, plus a completion bonus at month 5. Band is an estimate
Location	Mumbai, on site. Not remote: the role owns the server and the shop-floor data, and spends about one day a week at the machines
Type	Full time, permanent
Priority	Fill first. Shorter notice periods are typical for this profile, and the work can start before the Geometry Lead joins
Reports to	Founder

About the company

A precision CNC machine shop in Mumbai is building its own software, CAM/AUTO. The software reads a customer's 3D CAD model and drawing and writes the program that a CNC milling machine runs to cut the part. The app already works (79 releases, tested on the shop floor). We are hiring a small team to make it accurate enough for daily production and to add a feature that learns from every part cut. Three roles, one founder, one senior CNC programmer from the shop, and an AI coding assistant (Claude Code) on every desk.

The job in plain words

This person makes the software safe to change and gets it onto the shop floor. The app is one very large code file with no automatic testing. They split it into modules, set up automatic tests that run on every change (continuous integration), run the on-site server and database, and build the link that brings measurement results from the shop floor back into the software. Their first deadline is week 3: automatic tests green and today's accuracy measured on six real parts.

What they will do day to day

- Set up continuous integration (GitHub Actions on an on-site server) so every code change is tested automatically before it is accepted.
- Split a 12,600-line JavaScript file into modules and move it to TypeScript, step by step, without breaking it.
- Build and maintain the automated test suite: unit tests, browser tests (Playwright), and a test library of real parts.
- Set up and run the on-site Linux server: Docker, PostgreSQL database, backups, and a small web service.
- Build the measurement loop: a form and database that record what the measuring machine (CMM) found for each program.
- Run program dry-runs on the CNC machines with the senior CNC programmer and log the results.

Must-have skills (screen on these)

Skill	What it means in practice	Weight
TypeScript / JavaScript and Node.js	Writes it daily; has worked on a large existing codebase they did not create	Non-negotiable
Test automation	Has built an automated test suite from scratch: Playwright or Cypress for browser tests; Vitest, Jest or Mocha for unit tests	Non-negotiable
Continuous integration	Has set up GitHub Actions, GitLab CI or Jenkins pipelines from nothing, including self-hosted runners	Non-negotiable
Linux server and Docker	Has administered a Linux server: Docker Compose, backups, basic networking	Non-negotiable
Database	PostgreSQL or similar: schema design, migrations, backups	Required
Python	Working knowledge: scripts, CSV handling, pandas	Required
Git	Daily use, pull-request reviews, release tagging	Required

Good to have (not required)

- Experience in manufacturing, industrial or IoT software.
- Can read basic CNC G-code or is willing to learn in the first month.
- Fastify (Node) or FastAPI (Python) for small web services.
- Property-based testing, golden-file testing.
- Has migrated a legacy codebase (monolith to modules, JavaScript to TypeScript).

Not a match (please do not send)

- Manual QA testers with no coding.
- Cloud-only DevOps (AWS, Azure, Kubernetes) who do not write application code.
- Front-end-only developers.
- Candidates who will not work on site or on a factory floor.

Where to find candidates

Companies	Product start-ups known for strong engineering practice; industrial software and IoT companies; engineering-software companies with SDET or platform teams; SaaS companies with Node.js stacks
Job titles to search	SDET, Software Development Engineer in Test, Test Automation Engineer, Platform Engineer, DevOps Engineer, Build and Release Engineer, Full-stack Engineer (Node.js), Infrastructure Engineer

Screening questions HR can ask

Question	Answer to listen for
Have you set up a CI pipeline from scratch? Which tool?	GitHub Actions, GitLab CI or Jenkins, with details on runners and what the pipeline ran
Which browser test tool have you used?	Playwright preferred; Cypress acceptable; Selenium only is weak
Do you write Node.js or TypeScript every day?	Must say yes
Have you run a Linux server with Docker and backups?	Yes, with details
Will you spend about one day a week on a factory floor, and work on site in Mumbai?	Must say yes

Hiring process

1. Short call with the founder (30 minutes).
2. Paid one-day practical test on real material. The candidate is paid for the day whether or not we proceed.
3. Two-hour review of the test at the shop, in front of the machine.
4. Reference calls, then an offer within a week.

Keywords

Must-have keywords (resume should show most of these)

TypeScript, JavaScript, Node.js, Playwright, test automation, SDET, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, self-hosted runner, Docker, Docker Compose, Linux, PostgreSQL, Git

Good-to-have keywords

Vitest, Jest, Cypress, esbuild, Python, pandas, FastAPI, Fastify, nginx, SQLite, property-based testing, golden tests, monolith migration, legacy refactoring, release engineering, backups, on-premises, manufacturing software, G-code, CMM

Boolean search string (LinkedIn Recruiter, Naukri)

("Node.js" OR "TypeScript") AND ("Playwright" OR "Cypress" OR "test automation" OR "SDET") AND ("GitHub Actions" OR "GitLab CI" OR "Jenkins" OR "CI/CD") AND ("Docker" OR "Linux")

Titles and profiles to skip

manual tester, QA analyst (manual), AWS solutions architect, Kubernetes administrator, cloud architect, React developer (front-end only)